

PREFACE TO THE AMERICAN EDITION.

THE accurate and exhaustive treatise of Mr. Lewin can receive no warmer nor more effective commendation than that which voluntarily or unconsciously falls from the lips of every reader.

The English cases have been brought down to date, and this part of the work has been excellently done by a F. Heard, Esq.

The text has been modified and corrected as indicated in the "addenda et corrigenda" of the eighth English edition.

In the American notes the attempt has been made to show the difference between English and American decisions, to cite the leading cases upon the subjects treated and to briefly indicate the substance of the decisions.

To know where knowledge is, is next to having it, and, if the reader finds his attention directed to such cases as he seeks, his perusal of them renders any lengthy abstracts or quotations unnecessary.

In so far as these annotations are found numerous, accurate and comprehensive enough to afford any assistance, to that extent it will be felt that this labor has not been in vain.

J. H. F.

Boston, *May*, 1888.